SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

4 August 2021 · Shift 2

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To go red in the face

(A) To shout at someone for doing something wrong
(B) To feel embarrassed
(C) To feel very happy and proud
(D) To feel extremely irritated

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. His jokes “fell flat” on the audience.

(A) deeply touched
(B) failed to have an effect
(C) irritated
(D) provoked laughter

Q.3

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. She said to her friend, “Will you take my dog for a walk?”

(A) She asked her friend that if she will take her dog for a walk.
(B) She asked her friend will she take her dog for a walk.
(C) She asked her friend if she would take her dog for a walk.
(D) She asked to her friend if she would take my dog for a walk.

Q.4

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. This train is _____ for Bihar.

(A) bound
(B) going
(C) running
(D) intending

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution’. We were quite impressed with the enthusiasm “that she work for”.

(A) that she is working on
(B) that she worked with
(C) which she works for
(D) No substitution

Q.6

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. On the other, there is the principle of leadership. B. Democracy rests on a tension between two different principles. C. While the first gives priority to rules, the second gives importance to persons. D. On the one hand, there is the principle of equality before the law, or more generally, equality.

(A) BDAC
(B) CDAB
(C) DACB
(D) ADBC

Q.7

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. a person who formally requests something, especially a job

(A) applicant
(B) trainee
(C) contestant
(D) nominee

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Continuing for a long time

(A) Profound
(B) Project (v)
(C) Prolonged
(D) Infinite

Q.9

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. All our / furnitures were / spoiled in the recent / rains and floods.

(A) furnitures were
(B) rains and floods
(C) spoiled in the recent
(D) All our

Q.10

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. WISDOM

(A) stupidity
(B) youth
(C) stability
(D) maturity

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. COMPLY

(A) obey
(B) adore
(C) decline
(D) deny

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Feature
(B) Torches
(C) Sacrifice
(D) Highlite

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. I “practised for” the debate; that's why I am late.

(A) No substitution required
(B) am practising for
(C) was practising for
(D) have practised for

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Dearth

(A) Death
(B) Weakness
(C) Leakage
(D) Shortage

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Weird

(A) Apparent
(B) Normal
(C) Abnormal
(D) Wide

Q.16

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. If the test booklet seal is broken or _____ with, bring it immediately to the notice of the invigilator.

(A) adjusted
(B) opened
(C) tampered
(D) closed

Q.17

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. As soon as the bus driver was seeing the child crossing the road, he applied the brakes.

(A) As soon as the bus driver
(B) was seeing the child
(C) crossing the road
(D) he applied the brakes

Q.18

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. On coming out, his skin would be shining like ebony and he would squeal with pleasure. B. First, he would lie down on the sand bank while I rubbed him clean with the sand of the river. C. Every day, I used to take the baby elephant to the river for his bath. D. After that, he would lie in the water for a long time.

(A) ADCB
(B) DABC
(C) BADC
(D) CBDA

Q.19

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in the active or passive voice. Designer clothes were sold to the masses by Pierre Cardin.

(A) The masses were sold by Pierre Cardin to the designer clothes.
(B) Designer clothes have been sold by Pierre Cardin to the masses.
(C) Pierre Cardin sold designer clothes to the masses.
(D) Pierre Cardin had sold designer clothes to the masses.

Q.20

Select the misspelt word.

(A) accomodate
(B) annihilate
(C) appropriate
(D) accelerate

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. 'SkillSet' was founded in 2014 to collect and co-ordinate (1) _____ about educational access and quality for students with special needs and disabilities. The organisation (2) _____ thousands of enquiries every year and offers (3) _____ to students on how to apply to colleges and universities across the country and how to find out about special (4) _____ and scholarships. We ensure easy access to higher education for all students, (5) _____ those with disabilities. Your donations and suggestions will help us to improve our service to customers and you will also be helping us to continue our valuable work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) funding
(B) admissions
(C) information
(D) officials

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. 'SkillSet' was founded in 2014 to collect and co-ordinate (1) _____ about educational access and quality for students with special needs and disabilities. The organisation (2) _____ thousands of enquiries every year and offers (3) _____ to students on how to apply to colleges and universities across the country and how to find out about special (4) _____ and scholarships. We ensure easy access to higher education for all students, (5) _____ those with disabilities. Your donations and suggestions will help us to improve our service to customers and you will also be helping us to continue our valuable work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) passes
(B) receives
(C) transmits
(D) sends

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. 'SkillSet' was founded in 2014 to collect and co-ordinate (1) _____ about educational access and quality for students with special needs and disabilities. The organisation (2) _____ thousands of enquiries every year and offers (3) _____ to students on how to apply to colleges and universities across the country and how to find out about special (4) _____ and scholarships. We ensure easy access to higher education for all students, (5) _____ those with disabilities. Your donations and suggestions will help us to improve our service to customers and you will also be helping us to continue our valuable work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) comments
(B) conditions
(C) advice
(D) instructions

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. 'SkillSet' was founded in 2014 to collect and co-ordinate (1) _____ about educational access and quality for students with special needs and disabilities. The organisation (2) _____ thousands of enquiries every year and offers (3) _____ to students on how to apply to colleges and universities across the country and how to find out about special (4) _____ and scholarships. We ensure easy access to higher education for all students, (5) _____ those with disabilities. Your donations and suggestions will help us to improve our service to customers and you will also be helping us to continue our valuable work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) systems
(B) facilities
(C) effects
(D) purposes

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. 'SkillSet' was founded in 2014 to collect and co-ordinate (1) _____ about educational access and quality for students with special needs and disabilities. The organisation (2) _____ thousands of enquiries every year and offers (3) _____ to students on how to apply to colleges and universities across the country and how to find out about special (4) _____ and scholarships. We ensure easy access to higher education for all students, (5) _____ those with disabilities. Your donations and suggestions will help us to improve our service to customers and you will also be helping us to continue our valuable work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) excluding
(B) especially
(C) additionally
(D) except

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the word-pair in which the two words are related in the same way as are the two words in the following word-pair. Language : Telugu

(A) Hindi : India
(B) Vehicle : Mechanic
(C) Continent : Asia
(D) Society : Service

Q.2

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. Z H _ O R C _ _ K _ R _ Z H _ O _ C

(A) Z, H, K, O, C, K, R
(B) K, Z, H, K, R, K, R
(C) K, Z, H, O, C, K, R
(D) K, Z, O, R, C, K, R

Q.4

In a code language, if RAFT is written as 180 and DON is written as 99, then how will SHOWER be written in the same language?

(A) 448
(B) 225
(C) 165
(D) 528

Q.5

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All trucks are cars. No wheel is a car. No car is a bus. Conclusions: I. No bus is a truck. II. No wheel is a bus. III. Some cars are trucks.

(A) All the conclusions follow.
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(C) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and III follow.

Q.6

Barun is the son of Chetan. Advita and Chetan are a married couple. Prakul is the brother of Chetan. Diya is the daughter of Advita. Suman is the brother of Barun. How is Diya related to Barun?

(A) Aunt
(B) Mother
(C) Sister
(D) Cousin

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the sixth number is related to the fifth number. 3 : 65 : : 5 : ? : : 4 : 126

(A) 217
(B) 166
(C) 344
(D) 216

Q.9

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (42, 14, 294)

(A) (30, 16, 242)
(B) (34, 18, 306)
(C) (21, 15, 205)
(D) (36, 21, 360)

Q.10

In a certain code language, BACK is written as YEXP and MIXTURE is written as NOCGAII. How will FROGS be written in that language?

(A) VIVTH
(B) UILTG
(C) UULTG
(D) UIUTH

Q.11

Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) KPUZ
(B) TYDI
(C) LQVA
(D) BGLP

Q.12

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
14, 16, 34, 104, 418, ?

(A) 2158
(B) 1894
(C) 1560
(D) 2092

Q.14

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Presume 2. Prepare 3. Priority 4. Prince 5. Prick

(A) 2, 1, 5, 3, 4
(B) 1, 2, 5, 4, 3
(C) 2, 1, 5, 4, 3
(D) 2, 1, 4, 5, 3

Q.15

What was the day of the week on 22 February 2012?

(A) Friday
(B) Wednesday
(C) Tuesday
(D) Thursday

Q.17

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Africa : Algeria : : South America : ?

(A) Canada
(B) Argentina
(C) Mexico
(D) Germany

Q.18

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 21 + 5 – 45 × 9 ÷ 3 = 11

(A) + and –
(B) + and ×
(C) ÷ and ×
(D) × and –

Q.19

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

(A) Oslo
(B) Baht
(C) Peso
(D) Rial

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term.
POSTED : TPQEFU : : COUNTS : ?

(A) VPDTUO
(B) VPTDOW
(C) VPETVO
(D) UQDTUO

Q.23

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different.

(A) 322 : 18
(B) 289 : 17
(C) 225 : 15
(D) 484 : 22

Q.25

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (4, 3, 73)

(A) (7, 5, 345)
(B) (5, 4, 141)
(C) (6, 2, 230)
(D) (5, 7, 302)

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Which of the given Articles of the Constitution of India mentions the following? "There shall be a council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President who shall in the exercise of his functions, act in accordance with such advice."

(A) Article 71(1)
(B) Article 71(2)
(C) Article 74(1)
(D) Article 74(2)

Q.2

In which country was the World Snooker Championship 2020 held from 31 July to 16 August 2020?

(A) England
(B) Germany
(C) Switzerland
(D) France

Q.3

In which year did India host the Commonwealth Games?

(A) 2018
(B) 2010
(C) 2006
(D) 2014

Q.4

What is the generic name of calcium sulphate hemihydrate?

(A) Baking soda
(B) Plaster of Paris
(C) Detergent powder
(D) Vinegar

Q.5

Which of the following rivers originates from the state of Rajasthan?

(A) Narmada
(B) Banas
(C) Mahi
(D) Chambal

Q.6

Who was the ruler of Delhi sultanate when Ibn Batuta came in India?

(A) Alauddin Khalji
(B) Firuz Shah Tughlaq
(C) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
(D) Ibrahim Lodi

Q.7

Which of the following keyboard shortcuts will you press in order to minimise all programs on a computer screen and display the desktop?

(A) Windows + C
(B) Windows + M
(C) Windows + F
(D) Windows + D

Q.8

Which has been India's most successful sport in the history of Olympic games having won medals maximum number of times till December 2020?

(A) Badminton
(B) Football
(C) Wrestling
(D) Field Hockey

Q.9
In which of the following caves is the painting named ‘Padmapani Bodhisattva’ found?

(A) Ajanta Cave No. 4
(B) Ajanta Cave No. 2
(C) Ajanta Cave No. 3
(D) Ajanta Cave No. 1

Q.10
Down Syndrome, which causes learning difficulties and physical health development delays and disabilities, is a:

(A) bacterial disease
(B) genetic disease
(C) viral disease
(D) fungal disease

Q.11
Who among the following became the youngest speaker of Lok Sabha till March 2021?

(A) Ganti Mohana Chandra Balayogi
(B) Meira Kumar
(C) Sumitra Mahajan
(D) PA Sangma

Q.12
_____ launched 'Harit Path', a mobile app, in 2020.

(A) National Highways Authority of India
(B) Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana
(C) Central Public Works Department
(D) Public Works Department of Delhi

Q.14
CorelDraw is an example of a/an:

(A) database software
(B) accounting software
(C) spreadsheet software
(D) desktop publishing software

Q.15
What minimum support price per quintal of groundnut has been declared by the Government of India for the marketing season 2020-21?

(A) ₹5275
(B) ₹6765
(C) ₹6285
(D) ₹4795

Q.16
Mirzai and bandi (types of jackets in white or black) are popular in the _____ region/s.

(A) Ladakh and Kashmir
(B) Bundelkhand and Malwa
(C) Western Ghat
(D) North Eastern

Q.17
What do you call the point in the orbit of the moon or a satellite at which it is nearest to Earth?

(A) Perigee
(B) Eclipse
(C) Apsis
(D) Apogee

Q.18
Which of the following types of rocks are formed by the lithification process?

(A) Sedimentary rocks
(B) Metamorphic rocks
(C) Igneous rocks
(D) Primary rocks

Q.19
Bhaskaravarman of the Varman dynasty ruled in the _____ region.

(A) Kamarupa
(B) Ujjain
(C) Magadha
(D) Vaishali

Q.20

Who among the following took charge as the CEO and Managing Director of HDFC Bank in October 2020?

(A) Sashidhar Jagdishan
(B) Rakesh Sharma
(C) Sandeep Bakhshi
(D) Amitabh Chaudhry

Q.21

Convention on the prohibition of the use of nuclear weapons and reducing nuclear danger under the nuclear weapons cluster were two resolutions sponsored by India that _____ adopted in 2020.

(A) UN General Assembly
(B) World Health Organization
(C) World Bank
(D) International Labour Organization

Q.22

Which of the following organisations released the 'Global Economic Freedom Index 2020 Annual Report'?

(A) Germanwatch
(B) StartupBlink
(C) The Heritage Foundation
(D) World Economic Forum

Q.23

Which of the following is NOT a use of washing soda?

(A) It can be used as a cleaning agent for domestic purposes.
(B) It is used in glass, soap and paper industries.
(C) It is used to make drinking water free from germs.
(D) It is used for removing permanent hardness of water.

Q.24

In 2020, the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded jointly to Harvey J Alter, Michael Houghton and Charles M Rice for the discovery of:

(A) Norwalk virus
(B) Epstein-Barr virus
(C) tobacco mosaic virus
(D) hepatitis C virus

Q.25

Which Indian actor was conferred with the 'Most Inspiring Indian Bollywood Actor' award in the UK in 2019?

(A) John Abraham
(B) Nawazuddin Siddique
(C) Sanjay Kapoor
(D) Boman Irani

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) To feel embarrassed

To 'go red in the face' is to blush with shame or awkwardness: to feel embarrassed.

Q.2 · Answer (B) failed to have an effect

To 'fall flat' is to fail to produce the intended effect: the jokes drew no laughs.

Q.3 · Answer (C) She asked her friend if she would take her dog for a walk.

A yes/no question is reported with 'asked ... if'; 'will' becomes 'would' and 'my' becomes 'her': 'She asked her friend if she would take her dog for a walk.'

Q.4 · Answer (A) bound

A train 'bound for' a place is on its way there.

Q.5 · Answer (B) that she worked with

One works 'with' enthusiasm, and the past tense matches 'were impressed': 'the enthusiasm that she worked with'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) BDAC

B names the tension between two principles, D gives the first ('On the one hand ... equality'), A the second ('On the other ... leadership') and C contrasts them: BDAC.

Q.7 · Answer (A) applicant

An applicant is a person who formally applies for something, such as a job.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Prolonged

'Prolonged' means continuing for a long time. 'Infinite' means without end, and 'profound' means deep.

Q.9 · Answer (A) furnitures were

'Furniture' is uncountable and has no plural: 'All our furniture was spoiled'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) stupidity

The opposite of 'wisdom' is 'stupidity'. 'Maturity' is close in meaning.

Q.11 · Answer (A) obey

To 'comply' is to act as asked or required: to 'obey'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Highlite

The correct spelling is 'highlight'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) was practising for

SSC's key gives 'was practising for': the past continuous presents the practice as an activity that was going on and kept the speaker, the usual way to explain being late. The simple past 'practised' is not ungrammatical, but it reports a finished event and explains the lateness less naturally.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Shortage

A 'dearth' is a scarcity or lack: a 'shortage'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Normal

'Weird' means strange or unusual; its opposite is 'normal'. 'Abnormal' is close to a synonym.

Q.16 · Answer (C) tampered

To 'tamper with' something is to interfere with it so as to damage or alter it.

Q.17 · Answer (B) was seeing the child

'See' is not normally used in the continuous, and 'as soon as' takes the simple past here: 'As soon as the bus driver saw the child'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) CBDA
C introduces the daily bath, B says what he did 'First', D what he did 'After that', and A describes him 'On coming out': CBDA.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Pierre Cardin sold designer clothes to the masses.
The simple past passive 'were sold by' becomes the simple past active 'sold', with the agent as subject: 'Pierre Cardin sold designer clothes to the masses.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) accomodate
The correct spelling is 'accommodate', with double 'c' and double 'm'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) information
The organisation was founded to collect and co-ordinate 'information' about educational access and quality.

Q.22 · Answer (B) receives
An organisation 'receives' enquiries; it does not pass, transmit or send them.

Q.23 · Answer (C) advice
It offers 'advice', that is guidance, to students on how to apply to colleges and universities.

Q.24 · Answer (B) facilities
Students with special needs look for special 'facilities' (and scholarships) at colleges and universities.

Q.25 · Answer (B) especially
'Especially' singles out those with disabilities, the group the organisation serves; 'excluding' and 'except' would contradict its aim.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) Continent : Asia
Telugu is one of the languages, as Asia is one of the continents: a class and a member of it.

Q.2 · Answer (C) K, Z, H, O, C, K, R
With K, Z, H, O, C, K, R in the blanks the block ZHKORC repeats: ZHKORC ZHKORC ZHKORC.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 528
The code is the sum of the letters' positions times the number of letters: RAFT = (18 + 1 + 6 + 20) × 4 = 180 and DON = (4 + 15 + 14) × 3 = 99. SHOWER = (19 + 8 + 15 + 23 + 5 + 18) × 6 = 88 × 6 = 528.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Both conclusions I and III follow.
All trucks are cars and no car is a bus, so no bus is a truck (I); and as all trucks are cars, some cars are trucks (III). Wheels and buses both lie outside the cars, but nothing relates them to each other, so II does not follow.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Sister
Advita is Chetan's wife, so Barun (Chetan's son) and Diya (Advita's daughter) are children of the same couple: Diya is Barun's sister.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 217
The second number is the cube of one more than the first, plus 1: $4^3 + 1 = 65$ and $5^3 + 1 = 126$. Likewise $6^3 + 1 = 217$.

Q.9 · Answer (B) (34, 18, 306)
The third number is half the product of the first two: 42 × 14 ÷ 2 = 294. Likewise 34 × 18 ÷ 2 = 306.

Q.10 · Answer (D) UIUTH
Each consonant is replaced by its opposite letter (B ↔ Y, C ↔ X, K ↔ P, M ↔ N) and each vowel by the next vowel (A → E, I → O, U → A, E → I). So F → U, R → I, O → U, G → T and S → H: UIUTH.

Q.11 · Answer (D) BGLP
In KPUZ, TYDI and LQVA each letter is 5 places after the one before it (wrapping round after Z). BGLP moves +5, +5, then +4, so it is the odd one.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 2092
Each term is the one before times 1, 2, 3, 4, ... plus 2: 14 × 1 + 2 = 16, 16 × 2 + 2 = 34, 34 × 3 + 2 = 104, 104 × 4 + 2 = 418, so 418 × 5 + 2 = 2092.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 2, 1, 5, 4, 3
In dictionary order: Prepare (2), Presume (1), Prick (5), Prince (4), Priority (3). 'Prep' comes before 'Pres', and 'Pric' before 'Prin' and 'Prio'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Wednesday
1 January 2012 was a Sunday. 22 February is 31 + 21 = 52 days later, and 52 = 7 × 7 + 3, so it falls three days after Sunday: Wednesday.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Argentina
Algeria is a country in Africa; likewise Argentina is in South America. Canada and Mexico are in North America, Germany in Europe.

Q.18 · Answer (C) ÷ and ×
Interchanging ÷ and ×: 21 + 5 – 45 ÷ 9 × 3 = 21 + 5 – 15 = 11.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Oslo
Baht, peso and rial are currencies; Oslo is a city, the capital of Norway.

Q.22 · Answer (A) VPDTUO
Each half is moved one letter forward and reversed: POS → QPT → TPQ and TED → UFE → EFU. So COU → DPV → VPD and NTS → OUT → TUO: VPDTUO.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 322 : 18
289, 225 and 484 are the squares of 17, 15 and 22. $18^2 = 324$, not 322, so 322 : 18 is the odd one.

Q.25 · Answer (B) (5, 4, 141)
The cube of the first number plus the square of the second gives the third: $4^3 + 3^2 = 64 + 9 = 73$. Likewise $5^3 + 4^2 = 125 + 16 = 141$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Article 74(1)
Article 74(1) provides for a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise the President, who shall act in accordance with its advice.

Q.2 · Answer (A) England
The 2020 World Snooker Championship, delayed by the pandemic, was played at the Crucible Theatre in Sheffield, England.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 2010
India has hosted the Commonwealth Games once, in Delhi in 2010.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Plaster of Paris
Calcium sulphate hemihydrate, $CaSO_4 \cdot \frac{1}{2}H_2O$, is Plaster of Paris, made by heating gypsum.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Banas
The Banas rises in the Aravalli hills of Rajasthan's Rajsamand district. The Chambal, the Mahi and the Narmada all rise in Madhya Pradesh.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
Ibn Battuta reached India in 1333 and served as a qazi at Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Windows + D
SSC's key gives Windows + D, which Microsoft lists as 'Display and hide the desktop': it minimises the open windows and brings the desktop in front of any that cannot be minimised (pressed again, it restores them). Windows + M only minimises the windows that can be minimised and leaves the rest on screen, so it is close but less exact.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Field Hockey
Field hockey has won India more Olympic medals than any other sport, including 8 gold medals.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Ajanta Cave No. 1
The Padmapani Bodhisattva is painted in Ajanta Cave No. 1.

Q.10 · Answer (B) genetic disease
Down syndrome is a genetic disorder, caused by an extra copy of chromosome 21 (trisomy 21).

Q.11 · Answer (A) Ganti Mohana Chandra Balayogi
G. M. C. Balayogi became Speaker of the Lok Sabha in 1998 at 46, the youngest so far.

Q.12 · Answer (A) National Highways Authority of India
The National Highways Authority of India launched the Harit Path app in August 2020 to monitor, through geo-tagged photographs, the trees planted along national highways.

Q.14 · Answer (D) desktop publishing software
CorelDRAW is a graphics design program used for drawings, layouts and print material: of these, desktop publishing software. It is not a database, accounting or spreadsheet program.

Q.15 · Answer (A) ₹5275
The minimum support price for groundnut in the 2020-21 kharif marketing season was ₹5,275 a quintal, ₹185 more than the year before.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Bundelkhand and Malwa
SSC's key gives Bundelkhand and Malwa: accounts of Madhya Pradesh's traditional dress describe the bandi or mirzai, a jacket in white or black, as part of men's attire in these two regions.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Perigee
The perigee is the point of an orbit nearest the Earth; the apogee is the farthest.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Sedimentary rocks
Lithification is the compaction and cementation of deposited sediment into rock: it forms sedimentary rocks.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Kamarupa
Bhaskaravarman, a contemporary and ally of Harshavardhana, ruled Kamarupa, in present-day Assam.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Sashidhar Jagdishan
Sashidhar Jagdishan succeeded Aditya Puri as HDFC Bank's MD and CEO in October 2020.

Q.21 · Answer (A) UN General Assembly
The UN General Assembly's First Committee, on disarmament, adopted India's resolutions 'Convention on the Prohibition of the Use of Nuclear Weapons' and 'Reducing Nuclear Danger' in November 2020; India has tabled them since 1982 and 1998.

Q.22 · Answer (C) The Heritage Foundation
SSC's key gives The Heritage Foundation, the only one of these that publishes an economic freedom index: its annual Index of Economic Freedom (India 120th in 2020). The 'Economic Freedom of the World: 2020 Annual Report', which ranked India 105th, is the Fraser Institute's, and it is not among the options.

Q.23 · Answer (C) It is used to make drinking water free from germs.
Making drinking water free from germs is a use of bleaching powder. Washing soda (sodium carbonate) is used for cleaning, in the glass, soap and paper industries and to remove permanent hardness of water.

Q.24 · Answer (D) hepatitis C virus

Alter, Houghton and Rice shared the 2020 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for the discovery of the hepatitis C virus.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Sanjay Kapoor

Sanjay Kapoor received the award at an event in the House of Commons, London, in 2019.

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